Anxiety and Related Disorders ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Learn With PsycLearn Essentials

Module 2
Introduction to Psychological Disorders

Module 3
Opening to Anxiety Disorders

Module 4
Components of Anxiety

Components of Anxiety

- ✓ Pause and Reflect: An Angry Dog
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- ✓ Diverse Manifestations of Anxiety Disorders
  Reading • 3 min
- ✓ Manifestations of Intense Anxiety
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Check Your Understanding: Components of Anxiety
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%

Autonomic Nervous System

- ✓ Components of the Human Nervous System
  Video • 3 min
- ✓ Organs and Internal Systems Involved in Anxiety
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Going Up the Sky Tower
  Video • 2 min
- ○ **The Components of the Autonomic Nervous System**
  Reading • 1 min
- ○ Check Your Understanding: Autonomic Nervous System
  Practice Assignment • 2 min
- ○ Activity: Components of Anxiety
  Practice Assignment • 5 min

Key Takeaways

- ○ Key Takeaways: Components of Anxiety
  Reading • 10 min

Module 4 Quiz

- ○ Module Quiz: Components of Anxiety
  Graded Assignment • 10 min

Module 5
Disorders that Involve Anxiety Part 1

Module 6
Disorders that Involve Anxiety Part 2

Module 7
Conclusion

Module 8
Cumulative Quiz

Module 9
Course Resources

Module 10
PsycLearn Essentials APA Student Resources

The Components of the Autonomic Nervous System

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The ANS has two components: the sympathetic nervous system (SNS) and the parasympathetic nervous system (PNS). These two systems complement each other to help the body deal with short-term stress and long-term maintenance, respectively. The SNS activates the body to deal with threats the person faces in the short term, and the PNS returns the body's processes to normal for long-term maintenance. Consider, for example, the process of digestion. When you are feeling anxious about going up a skyscraper, your body does not need to direct energy to help digest a meal you ate recently. Instead, the SNS shuts down the process of digestion, to devote more energy to dealing with the stress of riding the elevator up the skyscraper. After you're done viewing the sights and are stepping back on solid ground, you feel your body relax a little. You feel safer again, and your body can return to its focus on long-term maintenance, including digesting food. Activation of the SNS is a normal physical response to a stressor. Like other manifestations of anxiety, the SNS response can be adaptive. It's only when anxiety starts to dominate your everyday life that it becomes a disorder.

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